

**Bylaws of the
Epsilon Lambda Chapter
Chi Omega Fraternity
Revised November 2023**

**Article I
Name**

The name of this organization shall be the Epsilon Lambda Chapter of the Chi Omega Fraternity.

**Article II
Mission, Vision, and Policies**

Section 1. Mission

- A. Chi Omega Fraternity is an intergenerational women's organization forever committed to our founding purposes:
- Friendship
 - Personal integrity
 - Service to others
 - Academic excellence and intellectual pursuits
 - Community and campus involvement
 - Personal and career development

Section 2. Vision

- A. Sisters inspired by our values who serve the world while keeping Chi Omega ever at heart.

Section 3. Policies

- A. The policies of this chapter, chartered by the Supreme Governing Council of the Chi Omega Fraternity, shall be in keeping with the stated purposes, mission, vision, and rules of the Fraternity.

**Article III
Members**

The requirements for membership shall be in accordance with the Bylaws and the *Book of Rules* of the Chi Omega Fraternity and the rules of Furman Panhellenic.

Section 1. New Members

- A. A new member shall be an undergraduate woman matriculated at Furman University who has been selected in accordance with the recruitment procedures of the Fraternity and

Furman Panhellenic, and who is actively working to fulfill the new member requirements. A new member has one calendar year in which to fulfill these requirements:

- New members must attain a 2.0 cumulative GPA based on a 4.0 system as a full-time student.
- New members must meet all financial responsibilities prior to initiation.
- New members are encouraged to participate in at least one quality activity including work, internships, or organizations at Furman.

Section 2. Active Members

- A. Active members are undergraduate women matriculated at Furman University who have completed the requirements of the new member period and have been initiated. They must be actively working to achieve their degree.
- B. Active members are encouraged to participate in at least two activities separate from Chi Omega. The Director of Campus Activities is responsible for annually collecting the list. These activities must:
 - Meet regularly
 - Advance personal development
 - Enrich the college experience

Section 3. Transfer/Affiliates

- A. An initiated member from another chapter wishing to affiliate with the Epsilon Lambda Chapter must follow the Transfer/Affiliation Procedure outlined in the *Book of Rules* of the Chi Omega Fraternity.
- B. Upon completion of one semester at Furman University, this member must have a minimum Furman GPA of 2.7.
- C. Approval of this potential affiliate is left up to the discretion of the Executive Board.

Article IV Dues and Fees

Section 1. Dues and Fees

- A. Dues and fees shall be determined every spring by resolution of the chapter.
- B. House Corporation Board fees shall be determined at the time the House Corporation budget is prepared, after consultation with the chapter officers and Alumnae Advisory Board.
- C. Membership dues may be paid in the following ways: a) payment at the beginning of each new fall or spring semester, b) payment in monthly (three) installments (by the 15th of each month) throughout each new fall or spring semester, or c) specialized plan as determined by an individual member and the G.N.V., as further explained in Section 6 of the Standing Rules.

- D. Members will sign a binding contract no later than the second chapter meeting of the year indicating their payment plan. Members who do not expect to be able to pay fall or spring dues by the assigned date may sign a promissory note to be signed by the member and G.N.V indicating a specific date that their dues should be paid.
- E. Additional dues and fees may be established by a vote of the chapter and are due on the date specified by the G.N.V. and the financial advisor.
- F. Mary Mlecko Scholarship Program: At the end of each semester, we will form an unbiased committee consisting of chapter members and advisors to distribute scholarships based on financial need for the following semester.

Section 2. Fines

- A. Fines shall be levied or work assigned for unexcused absences from mandatory functions. These fines will be due two weeks from the date of the event, unless otherwise determined by the Executive Board.
- B. All fines will go to the Mary Mlecko Scholarship fund unless otherwise noted.
- C. Failure to attend mandatory events will result in fines outlined in Section 5 of Standing Rules. Failure to attend additional mandatory events may result in monetary or work fines upon discretion of the executive board.
- D. At the end of each term, incomplete work fines will be converted into monetary fines as specified in Section 5 of Standing Rules.
- E. The Personnel Board and GNV may assess circumstances for a max on work fines as outlined in Section 5 of the Standing Rules.

Section 3. Payment

- A. Each member of the chapter must pay her dues and fees promptly and in accordance with the *Book of Rules* of the Chi Omega Fraternity. She will do so as outlined in Section 6 of the Standing Rules.

Article V

Meetings and Functions

Section 1. Mandatory Events

- A. Mandatory events are outlined in Section 4 of the Standing Rules.
- B. Chapter Meetings
- C. The Executive Board must announce mandatory activities and post them on the calendar two weeks prior to the event, unless unforeseen circumstances do not allow a two weeks notice.
- D. Failure to be present at roll call for Recruitment rounds, Prelude, designated Initiation shifts, including Model Initiate, and other mandatory events specified in the Standing Rules or by the Executive Board will result in a monetary fine equivalent to that assigned for an absence (See Standing Rules Section 5 and 6).

Section 2. Chapter Meetings

- A. Formal meetings will be held on Mondays on Furman's campus.
- B. If it is necessary due to unforeseen circumstances to change the date, time, or place of the chapter meetings, notice must be provided to every chapter member by the G.K.A. at their discretion.
- C. Members may attend chapter in informal attire, unless otherwise determined by the Executive Board.
- D. Members are allowed two excused absences from chapter meetings per semester. One is permitted for personal reasons, and one is permitted for academic reasons.

Section 3. Absences and Excuses

- A. Requests to be excused for chapter meetings and mandatory functions must be provided to the G.K.A. via excuses.chio@gmail.com at least 24 hours in advance.
- B. Excused absences are outlined in Section 5 of the Standing Rules.
- C. Excuses not received 24 hours before the event will result in the absence being unexcused unless an emergency arises.
- D. The G.K.A. reviews excuses, and the Executive Board may review appeals if requested by the G.K.A. The Executive Board has discretion to excuse any other circumstances than listed here, as they deem appropriate.
- E. The Personnel Board will discuss frequent unexcused absences with members as outlined in Section 5 of the Standing Rules.
- F. Excuses are valid only for the length of time of the conflict. Members must attend the remainder of chapter events.

Section 4. Quorum

A quorum for any meeting at which a vote will be taken shall be 2/3 of active members in good standing.

Article VI Officers

Section 1. Designation

- A. The officers of the Epsilon Lambda Chapter shall be:
 - President (G.H.)
 - Vice President (G.T.B.)
 - Secretary (G.K.A.)
 - Treasurer (G.N.V.)
 - Member Educator (G.M.)
 - Personnel Chair
 - Recruitment Chair
 - Panhellenic Delegate
 - Director of Programming

Section 2. Eligibility and Election

- A. The elections of officers shall be in accordance with the National Officer Selection procedure as stated in the *Book of Rules*.
- B. Elections will be held before the end of the fall term, at the time and place set by the Executive Board.
- C. In order to be slated for an office, a member must be in good standing and have every intention of being able to serve for both the spring and fall semesters; executive positions cannot be shared or split between two members, and members cannot hold executive positions while studying abroad.
- D. She must have a minimum GPA of 2.7. If an elected officer's cumulative GPA falls below a 2.7 or her term GPA falls below 2.0, she must resign her office.

Section 3. Vacancies

Vacancies among elected officers shall be determined by the remaining members of the Executive Board. Their nomination must be approved by the advisors and confirmed by the chapter with a $\frac{2}{3}$ vote.

Section 4. Duties

- A. The duties of the officers are listed in the *Leading the Way* materials.
- B. Each retiring officer is responsible for training her successor.
- C. An officer-training workshop led by the outgoing G.H. shall be held. Each outgoing and incoming officer and Advisory Board member is responsible for assisting with the planning and presentation.
- D. Each officer shall maintain a notebook and files relative to her office and give them to her successor.
- E. Officers will be personally responsible for budget overruns, as noted in the "Going Over Can Cost You" form, unless otherwise approved by the G.N.V. and the Financial Advisor, or by the Executive Board.

Section 5. Removal

An officer failing to perform the duties of office may be removed in accordance with the procedure outlined in the *Book of Rules* of the Chi Omega Fraternity.

Article VII Executive Board

Section 1. Members

The executive board shall consist of the slated officers of the chapter.

Section 2. Meetings

- A. Regular meetings of the executive board shall be held weekly, at an agreed-upon time.
- B. Notice of the regular meetings shall be provided to all members of the executive board via communication of the G.H.
- C. If it is necessary due to unforeseen circumstances to change the date, time, or place of the executive board meeting, notice must be provided to each executive board member.

Section 3. Other Requirements

- A. Executive Board members must function within an allotted budget. Any proposed expenditure over the budgeted amount must be brought to the attention of the G.N.V. for approval before the expenditure is made.

Article VIII Cardinal Cabinet Directors

Section 1. Composition

- A. The Cardinal Cabinet directors shall consist of a team of Directors and Chairs as outlined in the Standing Rules.
- B. At a minimum, the Cardinal Cabinet must include:
 - Sisterhood Director
 - Career and Personal Development Director
 - Philanthropy Director
 - Campus Activities Director
 - Social Director

Section 2. Selection and Eligibility

- A. Directors are appointed by the incoming G.H., Director of Programming, and others whom they see fit and must be approved by the Executive Board and the Advisory Board.
- B. In order to be appointed as director, a member must be in good standing and have every intention of being able to serve during three terms: spring, summer, and fall of the calendar year.
- C. She must have a cumulative GPA of 2.7. If a director's cumulative GPA falls below a 2.7 or her term GPA falls below 2.0, she must resign her position.

Section 3. Duties and Responsibilities

- A. Duties of the Cardinal Cabinet Directors are outlined in their notebooks.
- B. Cardinal Cabinet Directors are required to attend Cardinal Cabinet meetings as specified by the Director of Programming.
 - a. Failure to do so may result in the removal of a director.
- C. Cardinal Cabinet Directors will be given agenda time at chapter meetings.

- D. The Director must function within the allowable budget, as noted in the “Going Over Can Cost You” form. Directors will be personally responsible for budget overruns unless approved by the G.N.V. and the Financial Advisor or by the Executive Board.
- E. Cardinal Cabinet Directors are expected to maintain a notebook and files relative to their position and to give these to their successor.

Section 4. Removal

A Cardinal Cabinet director failing to perform the duties of office may be removed in accordance with the procedure outlined in the *Book of Rules* of Chi Omega Fraternity.

Article IX Scholarship

Section 1. Expectation

- A. Each member of the Epsilon Lambda chapter of Chi Omega is expected to maintain a cumulative 2.7 GPA.
- B. As a condition of the new member education, each new member must sign an authorization for the university administration to disclose her grades to the G.T.B. for as long as she is an Active Member of the chapter.

Section 2. Failure to Maintain Appropriate GPA

- A. An initiated or new member failing to meet the scholastic requirements shall be placed on scholastic probation as outlined in the *Book of Rules* of Chi Omega Fraternity.
- B. Academic Warning
 - a. An initiated member who fails to obtain a 2.7 GPA for a term shall be placed on academic warning.
 - b. She will meet with the G.T.B., Personnel Board, and Scholarship Advisor and any action taken will be based on the Fair Play Procedure in the Book of Rules.
 - c. If the initiated member is put on Academic Warning for two consecutive terms, she will be placed on academic probation.
 - d. The G.H., G.T.B., and Advisory Board may handle special circumstances on a case-by-case basis.
- C. Academic Probation
 - a. An initiated member who fails to obtain a cumulative 2.7 GPA or who fails to obtain a term GPA of a 2.7 for two consecutive semesters shall be placed on academic probation for the following term and will lose her voice and vote in chapter meetings. Further consequences will be determined by the personnel board.
 - b. The G.T.B. and Personnel Chair will conduct a meeting halfway through the term to check progress and determine whether the member may attend the second function (Semi Formal or Formal) of the semester.

- c. The G.T.B., Personnel Board, and Scholarship Advisor will work with the member according to the Fair Play Procedure and the Book of Rules.

Article X Recruitment

Section 1. Recruitment Rules

- A. The chapter shall abide by the rules established by Chi Omega Fraternity and Furman Panhellenic.
- B. The chapter shall evaluate the chapter's needs and establish a target for each recruitment period.
- C. Every initiated member in good standing is entitled to vote on the days in which she was present.

Section 2. Chapter Recruitment Team

- A. The chapter recruitment team executive board shall include the recruitment chair, the G.H., the personnel chair, the recruitment advisor(s), and the personnel advisor.
- B. Each member of the chapter is a member of the recruitment team and is required to give full support and participation.

Article XI Parliamentary Procedure

For procedures not covered in the Book of Rules or the Bylaws of this organization, current Robert's Rules of Order, Newly Revised, shall be parliamentary procedure.

Article XII Amendments

These bylaws may be amended annually by a two-thirds vote of the chapter members in attendance, provided the proposed amendments have been posted or have been read and discussed at the meeting prior to the meeting at which they are to be adopted.

Article XIII Finances

Section 1. Contracts

Contracts with bus companies, party locations, caterers, etc. must be signed by the Social Advisor in addition to either the G.H. or the Social Director. The contract also must be signed by at least one representative from the company providing the service and must be drawn up at least

twenty-four hours before the event. Contracts should include the exact price to be charged to the Epsilon Lambda chapter of Chi Omega.

Section 2. Checks

All Chi Omega checks must be signed by two of the following representatives: G.H., G.N.V., or Financial Advisor. All Checks over \$1,000 must have the approval of the Financial Advisor.

Section 3. Credit Card Privileges

If a chapter member uses the Chi Omega credit card belonging to G.H or G.N.V. for chapter expenses, she is required to deliver the proper receipts and documentation to the G.N.V. within one week of the purchase. If the member fails to do so, her card privileges are revoked for the rest of the semester.

Section 4. Special Funds

All Housing Corporation and Make-A-Wish money must be kept in separate accounts from chapter funds.

Article XIV Involvement System

Section 1. Objective

The objective of this system is to promote active, voluntary participation in activities associated with the six purposes of the Epsilon Lambda Chapter of the Chi Omega Fraternity.

Section 2. Events

Activities will be coordinated by the Cardinal Cabinet directors. Varying activities will occur on a regular basis. Categories for these events are outlined in Section 6 of the Standing Rules.

Section 3. Points

One point will be awarded to an activity correlating with one of the point categories outlined in Section 7 of the Standing Rules. Sisters must earn the allotted amount of points as determined by the Executive Board before social events. The Executive Board has the authority to make additional activities worth a point. Further information regarding point requirements is outlined in Section 7 of the Standing Rules.

Section 4. Record Keeping

Records will be kept by the G.K.A. and her assistant but maintained by the chapter.

Article XV

Social Functions

Section 1. Expectations of Members and Guests

- A. Chi Omegas must follow guidelines for behavior as laid out in Section 8 of Standing Rules.
- B. A Chi Omega's date must fulfill requirements laid out in Section 8 of Standing Rules.

Article XVI Dissolution

If for any reason Epsilon Lambda Chapter of Chi Omega Fraternity is dissolved, all property thereof belonging to the chapter, including real estate and all possessions, shall automatically be transferred to the Chi Omega Executive Headquarters, 3395 Players Club Parkway, Memphis, TN 38125.

Standing Rules

Section 1. Social Media

- A. Chapter members shall refrain from posting pictures, videos, or slogans hinting at use of alcohol or drugs on *any* form of social media.
 - a. If over the age of 21, a member may have a photo depicting *responsible* use of alcohol.
 - b. If under the age of 21, no alcohol should be shown, and there must be no present conditions in which the consumption of alcohol is assumed.
 - c. Regardless of age, no hashtags, captions, or actions in the picture may allude to anything related to Chi Omega if the use of alcohol is depicted.
 - d. Additionally, any social media post deemed unbecoming of Chi Omega may be asked to be removed upon discretion of the executive board.
- B. Chapter members shall refrain from posting pictures, videos, or slogans hinting at anything that may be considered offensive or politically incorrect.
- C. The use of "Chi O Til I Die-O" and "Show me your hooties" is prohibited, along with other similar phrases deemed inappropriate or unbecoming of Chi Omega.
- D. Consequences
 - a. An email and a text message will be sent to the member, and the photo/video/slogan in question will be attached.
 - b. The photo/video/slogan must be removed within 12 hours of the notification.
 - c. If the member fails to remove the photo/video/slogan within 12 hours, a formal personnel meeting will be held.
 - d. Upon the third violation of this rule, the member will be issued a formal personnel meeting. A personnel meeting will be held regardless of notice to take down the post.

Section 2: Pin Attire

- A. Formal pin attire is limited to business attire including dresses, skirts, professional slacks, and appropriate shoes. Cowboy boots, athletic sneakers, flip flops, outdoor sandals, Birkenstocks, denim pants and skirts, and pants with more than four pockets (two in the front, two in the back) are prohibited.
- B. Appropriate informal attire may be determined at the discretion of the Executive Board.

Section 3: Leadership Positions

- A. The Chapter's Cardinal Cabinet structure shall include the following director positions:
 - a. Sisterhood Director
 - b. Career and Personal Development Director
 - c. Make A Wish Director
 - d. External Philanthropy + Together Women Rise Director
 - e. Campus Activities Director + Intramurals + Moms Weekend/Dads Day
 - f. Social Director
 - g. Marketing Director
 - h. Social Media Director + Alumni Relations and Newsletter
 - i. DEI Director
 - j. Chaplain
- B. Additional leadership positions may be created or diffused by the executive board (ex. Chaplain, t-shirt chair). By the discretion of the Director of Programming, these positions may be added or removed from Cardinal Cabinet meeting requirements.

Section 4: Attendance

- A. Mandatory events include recruitment, recruitment workshops, initiation activities and shifts, philanthropy events, chapter meetings, officer slating, sisterhood retreats, Eleusinian, class experiences and other events determined mandatory by the Executive Board.
- B. Excused absences include but are not limited to:
 - a. Illness
 - b. Death in the family
 - c. Religious observations
 - d. Varsity athletics
 - e. Activities pre-approved by the G.K.A.
 - f. Scheduled classes
 - g. Employment conflict (Excluding recruitment workshops, slating, chapter, and Recruitment)
 - h. Job interviews
- C. Following the first unexcused absence of a mandatory event, the member will be required to have a personnel meeting. The second unexcused absence will result in the loss of voice and vote in chapter and a Personnel Board meeting. The third unexcused absence will result in appropriate action by the Personnel Board.

Section 5: Fines

A. Fines for missing mandatory events include:

Recruitment workshops	\$20/day
Recruitment	\$75/day
Prelude	\$20
Myth Night (for new members and seniors)	\$20
Initiation	\$25/one completed round
Model Initiation	\$25
Philanthropy Events	\$20 to MAW
Chapter Meetings	Work Fine or \$20 (after the second unexcused absence)
Officer Slating	\$50
Sisterhood Retreat	Work Fine
Eleusinian	Work Fine
Class Experience	Work Fine

- B. The monetary fines must be paid in full before the member can attend another social function.
- C. At the end of term, incomplete work fines will be converted into \$20 monetary fines.
- D. There shall be a limit of two (2) work fines and then a subsequent personnel meeting to assess circumstances for monetary fines, as deemed appropriate by the Personnel Board.

Section 6: Payment

- A. Members will receive exactly 2 reminders from the G.N.V., one on the 5th and one on the 10th, after which dues are due on the 15th of each month. Late fees will begin the 16th at \$5/day until dues are **received** according to Bill Highway unless you arrange an exception with the G.N.V. In addition, on the 16th, you will receive an email from the personnel chair to arrange a formal personnel meeting in the event that dues are not immediately paid.
 - a. She may be asked to sign a promissory note for the delinquent amount. At the time the note is signed, the member must set a date when the delinquency will be paid with the G.N.V. Failure to meet this agreement will result in revocation of membership.
- B. Promissory notes must be paid upon completion of each term. All outstanding fees or dues must be paid by the end of the academic year.

Section 7: Points

- A. The number of points required to attend social functions will be determined by the Executive Board and must be relayed to chapter as early as possible within a given semester.
- B. The Point Categories are
 - a. Sisterhood
 - b. Campus Activities
 - c. External Philanthropy

- d. Marketing
- e. Career and Personal Development
- f. Together Women Rise
- g. Scholarship
- C. Either-Or point opportunities are defined as points that could fulfill a point opportunity in one of two categories upon the member's discretion. .
- D. Students participating in a partial abroad program will fulfill a point requirement on a case-by-case basis at the discretion of the GKA.
- E. Their spring semester, seniors may earn the privilege of a reduced point requirement for Formal provided they:
 - a. accrue all points from the semester prior if they choose to attend the fall social functions
 - b. are in good standing with the chapter.

Section 8. Social

- A. Function Dates
 - a. If a date is sent home from two functions within a year from the first time he/she was asked to leave, he/she will not be allowed back to Chi Omega functions (Must wait one full calendar year before date can return)
 - b. Active members are permitted to bring disaffiliated members as a guest to Chi Omega social functions.
 - c. Displedged members may attend Chi Omega events as a guest with the approval of the Executive Board.
 - d. Guests must be at least 18 years of age unless deemed appropriate by the Executive Board.
- B. Damage of Property: Any misbehavior by a Member, New Member, or guest that results in a monetary fine to the Fraternity is to be paid by the Member or New Member responsible for herself or her guest.
- C. A member must follow transportation guidelines as relayed by the Personnel Chair and Executive Board.
- D. Chapter members will be asked to SPM voluntarily for events, in the event there are not enough volunteer SPMs then sophomores can be randomly picked to fulfill the required number.
 - a. If a member is asked to leave a function, she will be required to serve as an SPM for the following event. Other sanctions are determined by the personnel board.
- E. A member who fails to follow behavioral guidelines as specified by Chi Omega's national rules and policies, Epsilon Lambda's rules and policies, and Furman Panhellenic's rules and policies will meet with the personnel board.